Measuring Tape



Category: **Measuring & Marking Tools** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 42 labs

Covers these lab items: Inch Tape; Measuring 30 meter Tape; Measuring Tape; Measuring Tape (5m); Measuring tape and scale; Measuring tape and/or a ruler; Measuring Tape ISI Mark; Measuring tape, plumb; Measuring tape/ruler; Retractable Tape Measure; Tape; Tape Measure

What it is used for

A measuring tape measures length, distance, and dimensions for layout, inspection, or construction tasks. Use the correct tape length and read the scale carefully for accurate measurements.

How to use

1. Inspect the tape, markings, hook, lock, and casing for damage.
2. Select a tape with suitable length and units for the task.
3. Secure the tape's end at the starting point and align it with the measurement line.
4. Extend the tape straight without twists or unnecessary slack.
5. Read the measurement at eye level and use the correct reference edge.
6. Record the value with units and identify the measured dimension.
7. Retract the tape slowly using the lock and return it to storage.

⚠ Safety

- Keep fingers away from the tape edge when retracting it quickly.
- Do not use a metal tape near live electrical equipment.
- Avoid overstretching the tape or using a damaged hook or blade.
- Keep the work area clear to prevent trips and cuts.

Care & storage

- Wipe the tape clean and dry it before storage if it becomes wet.
- Retract gently and replace tapes with damaged markings or faulty locks.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.